004-08 PUBLIC WORKS AND SOCIAL WELFARE 公共工程和社会福利

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The interwar (a.) period **saw a greater interest** in public works 公共工程 and in social legislation 社会立法 and welfare 福利, both because of similar developments in Britain —where *laissez-faire (a.n.)自由放任的;放任政策；不干涉主义 economics* **was losing** popularity **to** the welfare state 福利国家 ideal 理想 —and because of the colonial government’ s determination to limit (v.) the growth of Chinese nationalism and labor consciousness 意识；觉悟.

Completed in 1937 and named 命名 **in honor of** King George V, 主 the Jubilee 周年纪念的 Reservoir 水库 in the New Territories 谓 boasted (v.)拥有（值得自豪的事物） the tallest dam in the British Empire.

1937年建成的新界 Jubilee 水库, 为纪念乔治五世国王而命名，它曾是大英帝国最高的水坝。

New roads were built, and *land reclamation (开垦；收回；再利用；矫正)土地开垦；填海造地 projects* occurred (v.) on both sides of the harbor.

Medical and sanitary 卫生的 services also expanded, the Malaria 疟疾 Bureau 局；办事处 was established in 1930, and the Urban Council 市政局,城市委员会 replaced (v.) the Sanitary Board 卫生局 in 1936.

The government Kowloon Hospital opened in 1926; begun in the late 1920s, the Queen Mary Hospital opened (v.) in Pokfulam 地名 on Hong Kong Island in 1937.

The Building Ordinance 建筑条例 of 1935 **set (v.) standards for** lighting and ventilation 通风, although **overcrowding 过度拥挤 continued** (v.) because of the influx of refugees 难民 from China.

More schools were built, both for Chinese and Europeans, as were 也,同样 several teachers’ training colleges 师范学院.

Example 1. 案例

这里的 as were 是一个倒装结构，表示“也”或“同样”。
- 正常语序：**as** several teachers’ training colleges **were (built)**
- 倒装语序：**as were** several teachers’ training colleges

为了避免重复（避免再次写出 built），同时为了强调这种“相似性”，英语习惯将 be动词（或助动词）提前，形成倒装。

又如:
- He is a doctor, **as is** his wife.（他是一名医生，他妻子也是。）
- She works very hard, **as do** all her colleagues.（她工作非常努力，她的所有同事也是如此。）

Example 2. 案例

The interwar period saw a greater interest in public works and in social legislation and welfare, both because of similar developments in Britain—where laissez-faire economics was losing popularity to the welfare state ideal—and because of the colonial government’s determination to limit the growth of Chinese nationalism and labor consciousness.
Completed in 1937 and named in honor of King George V, the Jubilee Reservoir in the New Territories boasted the tallest dam in the British Empire.
New roads were built, and land reclamation projects occurred on both sides of the harbor.
Medical and sanitary services also expanded, the Malaria Bureau was established in 1930, and the Urban Council replaced the Sanitary Board in 1936.
The government Kowloon Hospital opened in 1926; begun in the late 1920s, the Queen Mary Hospital opened in Pokfulam on Hong Kong Island in 1937.
The Building Ordinance of 1935 set standards for lighting and ventilation, although overcrowding continued because of the influx of refugees from China.
More schools were built, both for Chinese and Europeans, as were several teachers’ training colleges. 两次世界大战之间的时期, 人们对公共工程、社会立法和福利的关注度显著提高, 这既是因为英国也出现了类似的趋势——自由放任的经济政策逐渐被福利国家理念所取代——也是因为殖民政府决心限制中国民族主义和劳工意识的蔓延。1937年竣工并以乔治五世国王命名的银禧水库位于新界, 拥有当时大英帝国最高的堤坝。新的道路修建起来, 海港两岸也开展了填海造地工程。医疗卫生服务也得到了扩展, 疟疾防治局于1930年成立, 市政局于1936年取代了卫生局。政府运营的九龙医院于1926年开业。玛丽医院始建于20世纪20年代末, 于1937年在香港岛薄扶林正式开业。1935年的《建筑物条例》规定了照明和通风标准, 但由于大量来自中国的难民涌入, 医院仍然人满为患。此外, 还兴建了更多学校, 包括面向华人和欧洲人的学校, 以及数所师范学院。

As in Britain and the rest of the empire, there was more interest in *social welfare* 社会福利.

Social protection in Hong Kong before the British arrived 谓 had traditionally come from family, clan 宗族，氏族,帮派 and lineage <正式>血统，世系 organizations.

Example 3. 案例
clan

→ 来自苏格兰盖尔语clann,家族，种族，来自拉丁语planta,新枝，植物，后代。因盖尔语字母 p 不能用做首字母，因而用字母c 代替。比较pole,collar,cycle,来自PIE*kwel,转。

英 /klæn/ 美 /klæn/ 全球发音

简明 牛津 新牛津 韦氏 柯林斯 例句

clan *n.* /klæn/

[C+sing./pl.v.]

1. a group of families who are related to each other, especially in Scotland（尤指苏格兰的）宗族，氏族，家族
   - the Macleod clan麦克劳德氏族
   - clan warfare宗族冲突
2. (*informal* , sometimes*humorous*) a very large family, or a group of people who are connected because of a particular thing庞大的家族；宗派；帮派；小集团
   - one of a growing clan of stars who have left Hollywood脱离了好莱坞的那帮人数日益增多的明星中的一员

英语中, clan 和 lineage 的区别是什么?

Lineage 是“看得见、摸得着”的血缘实体，而 Clan 是“大框架下”的认祖归宗。

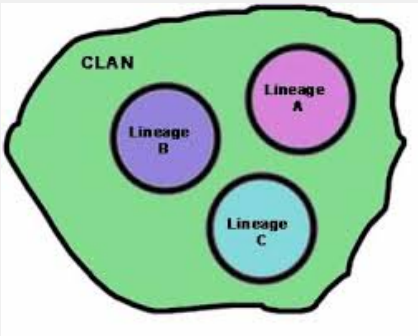
Header 1	Header 2
Lineage (宗族 / 支派) —— 实体的组织	**Lineage 指的是一群能清晰追溯到共同祖先的人。**在香港新界（New Territories）的历史中，Lineage 是社会组织的核心。 → 来自line,线，引申词义宗系，血统。 • 血缘清晰度： **成员能够准确说出自己是哪一代，祖先是谁。** • 共同财产： 这是一个关键特征。**Lineage 通常拥有共同的财产，如祠堂、族产（尝产）或土地。** • 功能性： **成员居住在一起（如同姓村），共同祭祖，并在内部提供社会保障（如资助贫穷子弟读书）。** • 通俗例子： 比如“新界邓氏”中某个村落的特定支系，他们共有一个祠堂，共享一块地。
Clan (氏族 / 姓族) —— 宽泛的认同	Clan 是一个更广泛的概念，成员拥有相同的姓氏，并**声称拥有共同的祖先，但往往无法具体证明每一代的血缘联系。** • 血缘模糊性： **成员可能分布在全国各地，**只要姓“张”，就认为几千年前是一家。 • 缺乏共同财产： 散布在不同地区的同姓人通常没有共同的土地或祠堂。 • 象征性： 它更多是一种身份认同或联谊。 • 通俗例子： **全世界的“李氏宗亲会”。虽然大家都姓李，但你并不认识其他地方的李姓人，也没有共同的家产。**

逻辑图示：包含关系

你可以这样理解它们的关系： **Clan (大圆：所有姓邓的人) → → → Lineage (小圆：锦田某村拥有祠堂的邓家人)**

在英国人到达香港之前，这种 Lineage（宗族）组织提供了极其强大的“社会保障”（Social protection）：
养老： 族产收益会分给老人。

教育： 资助族内子弟参加科举。
防御： 共同修建围墙和防御设施（如锦田吉庆围）。



Although European missionaries 传教士 ran (v.) orphanages 孤儿院 and other charitable 慈善的 institutions 机构；制度, until the 1920s social welfare **was largely confined to** Chinese organizations such as the Tung Wah Hospital and the Po Leung Kuk /**and to** rich residents such as Clara Ho Tung, wife of Robert Ho Tung and *a devout 虔诚的 Buddhist* who established temples and free schools for poor children in Hong Kong and Macau.

In the 1920s, however, the government began to take a more active role in providing social welfare.

This was a gradual 逐渐的；逐步的 process shaped (v.) by developments in Britain, China, and Hong Kong.

The idea of trusteeship (n.)托管制度；托管统治 rather than colonialism was becoming the norm 规范；常态, while 主 new social legislation 立法；法规 in Britain **due (a.)由于；因为 mainly to** 主要归因于 the rise of the Labour Party, trade unions 工会, and Socialists 社会主义者 谓 made the welfare state 福利国家 a popular alternative 替代品；选择 to *the nineteenth-century ideal* of laissez-faire 自由放任的 individualism 个人主义.

托管 (trusteeship) 的理念 (而非殖民主义) 正在成为规范, 与此同时, 英国的新社会立法 (主要归因于工党、工会和社会主义者的崛起) 使得福利国家 (welfare state) 成为了 19 世纪"自由放任个人主义 (laissez-faire individualism) 理想"的一个受欢迎的替代方案.

Example 4. 案例
due

英 /dju:/ 美 /du:/ 全球发音

简明 牛津 新牛津 韦氏 柯林斯 例句 百科

adj. n. adv.

due /dju:/

CAUSED BY 由于

1. [not before noun]~ to sth/sb caused by sb/sth; because of sb/sth由于；因为
   - The team's success was largely due to her efforts.这个队的成功在很大程度上是她努力的结果。
   - Most of the problems were due to human error.多数问题都是人为错误造成的。
   - The project had to be abandoned due to a lack of government funding.这项工程由于缺乏政府的资助而不得不放弃。

   HELP Some people think that it is more correct to use **owing to** to mean 'because of' after a verb or at the beginning of a clause, as **due** is an adjective.有人认为在动词之后或从句之首用owing to表示"因为"更合适，因为due是形容词。

EXPECTED 预期

2. [not before noun]~ (to do sth) | ~ (for sth) arranged or expected预定；预期；预计
   - When's the baby due?宝宝什么时候出世？
   - Rose is due to start school in January.罗斯一月份就要开始上学了。
   - The band's first album is due for release later this month.这个乐队的第一张唱片预定在本月下旬发行。
   - The next train is due in five minutes.下一班火车预计在五分钟后抵达。

   (especially *NAmE*)
   - My essay's due next Friday *(= it has to be given to the teacher by then)* .我的论文下周五必须交。

OWED 欠款

3. [not usually before noun]when a sum of money is **due** , it must be paid immediately到期
   - Payment is due on 1 October.付款期限为10月1日。

4. [not before noun]~ (to sb) owed to sb as a debt, because it is their right or because they have done sth to deserve it应支付；应给予；应归于
   - Have they been paid the money that is due to them?他们应得的钱付给他们了吗？
   - Our thanks are due to the whole team.我们要向全队致谢。

5. [not before noun]~ (for) sth owed sth; deserving sth应有；应得到
   - I'm still due 15 day's leave.我还应有15天的休假。
   - She's due for promotion soon.她很快该晋升了。

SUITABLE/RIGHT 适当；合适

6. [only before noun] (*formal*) that is suitable or right in the circumstances适当的；恰当的；合适的
   - After due consideration, we have decided to appoint Mr Davis to the job.经过适当考虑，我们决定委任戴维斯先生干这项工作。
   - to make due allowance for sth适当考虑某事

   (*BrE*)
   - He was charged with driving without **due care and attention** .他被控鲁莽驾驶。

   ——compare undue

IDIOMS 习语

1. **in ˌdue ˈcourse**

at the right time and not before 在适当的时候；到一定的时候

- Your request will be dealt with in due course.你的要求将在适当的时候予以处理。

——more at respect*n.*

The flow of refugees 难民；流亡者 from China soon exceeded 超过；超出 the capacity of voluntary 自愿的；志愿的 organizations to provide social welfare.

And although workers in Hong Kong were less politically conscious 有意识的；有觉悟的 **than** those in Canton, partly because they (especially those working for European employers, *who usually paid (v.) more* **than** Chinese employers) **were generally paid better** than in Canton, the government hoped to limit (v.) the growth of labor consciousness 意识；觉悟 by **marginally 轻微地；少量地;边缘地；在页边 improving** (v.) working and living conditions.

Example 5. 案例

As in Britain and the rest of the empire, there was more interest in social welfare.
Social protection in Hong Kong before the British arrived had traditionally come from family, clan, and lineage organizations.
Although European missionaries ran orphanages and other charitable institutions, until the 1920s social welfare was largely confined to Chinese organizations such as the Tung Wah Hospital and the Po Leung Kuk and to rich residents such as Clara Ho Tung, wife of Robert Ho Tung and a devout Buddhist who established temples and free schools for poor children in Hong Kong and Macau.
In the 1920s, however, the government began to take a more active role in providing social welfare.
This was a gradual process shaped by developments in Britain, China, and Hong Kong.
The idea of trusteeship rather than colonialism was becoming the norm, while new social legislation in Britain due mainly to the rise of the Labour Party, trade unions, and Socialists made the welfare state a popular alternative to the nineteenth-century ideal of laissez-faire individualism.
The flow of refugees from China soon exceeded the capacity of voluntary organizations to provide social welfare.
And although workers in Hong Kong were less politically conscious than those in Canton, partly because they (especially those working for European employers, who usually paid more than Chinese employers) were generally paid better than in Canton, the government hoped to limit the growth of labor consciousness by marginally improving working and living conditions. 与英国及其殖民地其他地区一样, 香港对社会福利的关注度也更高。在英国人到来之前, 香港的社会保障主要来自家族、宗族和世袭组织。尽管欧洲传教士开办了孤儿院和其他慈善机构, 但在20世纪20年代之前, 社会福利主要由东华医院、保良局等华人机构以及像何东夫人这样的富裕居民提供。何东夫人是何东的妻子, 是一位虔诚的佛教徒, 她在香港和澳门为贫困儿童创办了寺庙和免费学校。然而, 到了20世纪20年代, 政府开始在提供社会福利方面发挥更积极的作用。这是一个渐进的过程, 受到英国、中国和香港发展的影响。托管而非殖民主义的理念逐渐成为主流, 而英国新的社会立法（主要由于工党、工会和社会主义者的崛起）使得福利国家成为19世纪自由放任个人主义理想的一种受欢迎的替代方案。来自中国的难民涌入很快超过了志愿组织提供社会福利的能力。尽管香港工人的政治意识不如广州工人强烈（部分原因是他们的收入普遍高于广州工人, 尤其是那些为欧洲雇主工作、通常欧洲雇主支付更高工资的工人）, 但政府希望通过略微改善工作和生活条件来限制劳工意识的觉醒。

Social welfare and legislation 立法；法律 in Hong Kong were relatively progressive (a.)进步的；先进的, at least **in theory** /and when **compared to** other colonies 殖民地 such as Singapore or other Chinese cities such as Shanghai.

主 *The Industrial Employment 就业 of Children Ordinance* 条例；法令 of 1922, the first in East Asia, 谓 prohibited 禁止；阻止 the employment of children under age ten in factories /or under age twelve in “dangerous trades 行业；职业” such as carrying coal, building materials 建筑材料, or debris 残骸；碎片；废弃物; by the 1930s, child labor in factories had been largely eliminated 消除；根除,被淘汰.

Example 6. 案例

debris

→ de-, 分开，散开。-bris, 破开，词源同break, brittle. 即破成残骸的。

英 / ˈdebriː / 美 / dəˈbriː / 全球发音

简明 牛津 新牛津 韦氏 柯林斯 例句 百科

deb·ris *n.* /ˈdebriː/ /ˈdeɪ-/

[U]

1. pieces of wood, metal, brick, etc. that are left after sth has been destroyed残骸；碎片；破片
   - Emergency teams are still clearing the debris from the plane crash.各抢救小组仍在清理失事飞机的残骸。
2. (*formal*) pieces of material that are not wanted and rubbish/garbage that are left somewhere残渣；垃圾；废弃物
   - Clear away leaves and other garden debris from the pond.把池塘里的树叶和其他庭园垃圾清除干净。

The Factory Ordinance of 1927 appointed (v.) factory inspectors 检查员；视察员.
The same year, a labor division 部门；司；处 was established within the Secretary for Chinese Affairs.

The Industrial Employment of Women, Young Persons and Children Amendment 修正；修订 Ordinance of 1929 谓 regulated 控制；管理；调节 the employment of women in certain industries.

The Factories and Workshops Ordinance of 1932 谓 **kept** children under age sixteen and women **out of** dangerous trades such as fireworks 烟花；烟火, glass-making, lead 铅 processing 加工；处理, and vermilion-making 朱砂制造.

In 1938 the government appointed a labor officer **to deal with** unions 工会, labor conditions, and trade disputes.

Example 7. 案例

Social welfare and legislation in Hong Kong were relatively progressive, at least in theory and when compared to other colonies such as Singapore or other Chinese cities such as Shanghai.
The Industrial Employment of Children Ordinance of 1922, the first in East Asia, prohibited the employment of children under age ten in factories or under age twelve in “dangerous trades” such as carrying coal, building materials, or debris; by the 1930s, child labor in

factories had been largely eliminated.
The Factory Ordinance of 1927 appointed factory inspectors.
The same year, a labor division was established within the Secretary for Chinese Affairs.
The Industrial Employment of Women, Young Persons and Children Amendment Ordinance of 1929 regulated the employment of women in certain industries.
The Factories and Workshops Ordinance of 1932 kept children under age sixteen and women out of dangerous trades such as fireworks, glass-making, lead processing, and vermilion-making.
In 1938 the government appointed a labor officer to deal with unions, labor conditions, and trade disputes. 香港的社会福利和立法相对进步, 至少在理论上如此, 与其他殖民地（如新加坡）或中国其他城市（如上海）相比更是如此。1922年颁布的《工业童工雇佣条例》（东亚首例）禁止雇用10岁以下儿童在工厂工作, 或12岁以下儿童从事“危险行业”（如搬运煤炭、建筑材料或垃圾）；到20世纪30年代, 工厂童工现象已基本消除。1927年颁布的《工厂条例》设立了工厂督察员。同年, 在中华总局内部设立了劳工处。1929年颁布的《工业妇女、青年及儿童雇佣条例修正》规范了妇女在某些行业的雇佣。1932年颁布的《工厂及作坊条例》禁止16岁以下儿童和妇女从事烟火、玻璃制造、铅加工和朱砂制作等危险行业。1938年, 政府任命了一名劳工官员, 负责处理工会、劳工状况和劳资纠纷。

Still, the colonial government always tried not **to spend** too much **on** social welfare 社会福利, worrying that more immigrants 移民 would **pour in** from China if conditions in Hong Kong were too good.

“Even *at its mightiest* (最强大的)即使在最强大的时候,” writes historian David Faure, “Britain had no social policy 社会政策 on Hong Kong **as such** 就其本身而言；确切地说.”

In 1935 the government conceded 承认；让步 that /主 the “struggle for existence 生存斗争” in Hong Kong 系 was “very severe 严峻的；恶劣的” and that it would soon have to provide some sort of subsidized (a.)有补贴的 housing.

Corpses 尸体 were frequently abandoned in the streets, the families **too** poor **to arrange for** 安排 proper 合适的；体面的 burials 葬礼；安葬; the government reported *more than thirteen hundred such corpses* in 1937 alone.

Although colonial governors were encouraged to apply (v.) innovations 创新；改革 from other colonies, they were rarely **under great pressure** from the Colonial Office **to make any dramatic 巨大的；显著的 changes** in their respective 各自的 colonies.

Twice 两次 during the interwar period, for example, the Hong Kong government declined 拒绝；谢绝 **to pass (v.) legislation** 立法；法律 for *compulsory 强制的；义务的 workers’ compensation* 工人赔偿；工伤赔偿, **even though** it had been urged 敦促；力劝 to do so.

Although in 1938 /Governor Geoffrey Northcote argued that /the government must **increase (v.) taxation** 征税，税制；税款 to keep from 避免 reducing (v.) social services, neither government nor management 管理层；资方 **paid (v.) much attention to** the welfare 福利 of workers.

Example 8. 案例
taxation 和 tax 有什么区别?

简单来说：**Tax 是具体的“钱”，而 Taxation 是抽象的“制度”。**

Header 1	Header 2
Tax：具体的税款 (Specific & Concrete)	**Tax 通常指你实际支付的那笔钱，或者某种特定的税项。**它是可数名词。 侧重点： **具体的金额、种类, 或单次的缴费动作。** 例： • I need to pay my **income tax**.（我要交**个人所得税** —— 指那笔钱。） • The government **introduced a new tax** on luxury goods.（政府引入了一项新的奢侈品税 —— 指一种税种。）
Taxation：课税制度 (Abstract & Systemic)	Taxation 是一个不可数名词，**指的是征税的整个过程、行为或系统。** **侧重点： 宏观政策、征税行为、整体的税收总额。** 例 • *Taxation* is a way for the state to fund public services.（征税是国家资助公共服务的一种手段 —— 指整个系统。） • The 1938 proposal *for higher taxation*...（1938年关于增加课税的提议..... —— 这里指提高整体的征税力度/政策，而不是指某一张税单。）

本句中, "...the government must **increase taxation** to keep from reducing social services..."

这里使用 taxation 而不是 tax，是因为 Northcote 总督讨论的是政府的"宏观财政政策"。他不是在指某一项具体的、给个人的“税单”，而是在讨论通过“征税制度”来获取财政收入的行为。

语法小练兵:

- The government raised the __ on cigarettes. (这里指特定的税种) → tax
- Heavy __ can sometimes slow down economic growth. (这里指整体的征税负担) → taxation

A handful of 少数的 companies —usually European —**provided** their workers **with** decent 像样的；体面的 housing and working conditions, but most workplaces were dangerous and overcrowded.

In 1939, Labour Officer Butters reported that /*a tailoring 剪裁；裁缝业 establishment* (机构；大型组织；企业；旅馆)服装加工店；制衣厂 was “**so** overcrowded **that** 主 one male worker 后定说明 engaged in 从事；忙于 ironing 熨烫 谓 was found suspended (v.)悬挂；吊 from the roof on a beam 横梁 with his *ironing board* 熨衣板 suspended (v.) in front of him.”

Example 9. 案例
我问: 这里为什么用的是 was found suspended from, with his ironing board suspended 而不是 was found suspending from, with his ironing board suspending ?

► DeepSeek:

这里使用 suspended（过去分词）而不是 suspending（现在分词），**是因为这两个动作（“工人被悬挂”和“熨衣板被悬挂”）都是"被动"发生的，而不是"主动"进行的。**

Header 1	Header 2
was found suspended from the roof	结构：**find + 宾语 + -ed 过去分词：表示“发现某人/某物处于某种被动的状态”。** • He was found dead.（他被发现死了。）→ 死是被动的结果。 • He was found suspended.（他被发现被吊着。）→ 悬挂是被动的状态。
with his ironing board suspended in front of him	结构：**with + 宾语 + -ed过去分词 ： 表示“伴随着...处于某种被动的状态”。** • He stood there *with his hands tied*.（他站在那里，双手被绑着。） • He worked *with the board suspended*.（他工作，熨衣板被挂着。）

为什么不能用 suspending？ 如果强行使用 suspending，句子意思会变得非常奇怪：

- was found **suspending** from the roof：意味着工人被发现时，他正在主动地悬挂（某个东西）在屋顶上。这不符合逻辑，因为人不能“悬挂”一个动作。
- with his ironing board **suspending** in front of him：**意味着熨衣板自己正在主动地悬浮。**这听起来像熨衣板有了生命，自己在飘浮。

总结：
suspended 强调“被悬挂”的静态结果，而 suspending 强调“正在悬挂”的主动动作。 在这个句子中，无论是工人还是熨衣板，都是被外力置于空中的，因此必须使用表示被动的过去分词 suspended。

► ChatGPT:

英语会用 -ed过去分词, 来表达"结果状态"。

语言在这里几乎像摄影一样：不是描述动作过程，而是直接把最终的姿态摆在你眼前。

Header 1	Header 2
one male worker engaged in ironing **was found suspended from the roof**	one male worker *engaged in ironing* **was found suspended** from the roof 这里的 was found suspended 不是在描述他“正在把自己挂起来”，而是在描述被发现时的状态。 所以逻辑其实是： the worker was in a suspended position **英语常用 -ed 过去分词 表示这种“处于某种状态”。** 被发现时 是挂在屋顶梁上的状态。 类似的例子很多： He was found *lying on the floor*.（强调动作姿态） He was found *dead*.（状态） He was found *trapped in the building*.（状态） 如果写成：***x*** was found *suspending from the roof* 语义就变成："他 正在把自己悬挂起来". 就像一个人正在执行动作：He is suspending (v.)

Header 1	Header 2
	the lamp. 这显然不符合语境。
with his ironing board **suspended in front of him**	这里的 **with + 名词 + -ed过去分词**, 是英语非常常见的 with-结构，**用来描述"伴随状态"。** 例： He sat there *with his arms crossed*. She stood *with the door closed*. 她关着门站着. The man was lying *with his eyes shut*. **这些都不是"动作"，而是"状态"。** 所以：with his ironing board suspended in front of him 意思是：他的熨衣板 吊在他面前。. 如果改成： ✗ with his ironing board suspending 语义就变成：熨衣板 正在悬挂某个东西

Example 10. 案例

Still, the colonial government always tried not to spend too much on social welfare, worrying that more immigrants would pour in from China if conditions in Hong Kong were too good.
"Even at its mightiest," writes historian David Faure, "Britain had no social policy on Hong Kong as such."24 In 1935 the government conceded that the "struggle for existence" in Hong Kong was "very severe" and that it would soon have to provide some sort of subsidized housing.25 Corpses were frequently abandoned in the streets, the families too poor to arrange for proper burials; the government reported more than thirteen hundred such corpses in 1937 alone.
Although colonial governors were encouraged to apply innovations from other colonies, they were rarely under great pressure from the Colonial Office to make any dramatic changes in their respective colonies.
Twice during the interwar period, for example, the Hong Kong government declined to pass legislation for compulsory workers' compensation, even though it had been urged to do so.
Although in 1938 Governor Geoffrey Northcote argued that the government must increase taxation to keep from reducing social services, neither government nor management paid much attention to the welfare of workers.
A handful of companies—usually European—provided their workers with decent housing and working conditions, but most workplaces were dangerous and overcrowded.
In 1939, Labour Officer Butters reported that a tailoring establishment was "so overcrowded that one male worker engaged in ironing was found suspended from the roof on a beam with his ironing board suspended in front of him."26 尽管如此, 殖民政府始终尽量避免在社会福利方面投入过多资金, 担心如果香港的条件过于优越, 会有更多的移民从中国涌入。历史学家大卫·福尔写道："即使在其鼎盛时期, 英国也没有针对香港制定任何社会政策。" 1935 年, 政府承认香港的"生存困境"十分严峻, 并表示很快必须提供某种形式的补贴房屋。 尸体经常被遗弃在街头, 家属贫困无力安排体面的葬礼； 仅 1937 年一年, 政府就报告了超过 1300 具这样的尸体。尽管殖民地总督被鼓励借鉴其他殖民地的创新做法, 但殖民地事务部很少向他们施加巨大压力, 要求他们在各自的殖民地进行任何重大改革。例如, 在两次世界大战期间, 香港政府曾两次拒绝通过强制性工人赔偿法, 尽管有人敦促其这样做。尽管 1938 年总督杰弗里·诺斯科特辩称, 政府必须增加税收以避免削减社会服务, 但政府和管理层都对工人的福利关注甚少。少数公司——通常是欧洲公司——为工人提供体面的住房和工作条件, 但大多数工作场所危险且过度拥挤。1939 年, 劳工官员巴特斯报告说, 一家裁缝店"拥挤不堪, 以至于一名正在熨衣服的男工人被发现悬挂在屋顶的横梁上, 熨衣板也悬在他面前。" 26